FOR FAMILIES AND COMMUNITIES

Know your malaria risk



Malaria risk can change with the place and season.

In Botswana, rainy weather may increase mosquito breeding. Take extra care if you live in or visit an area where malaria occurs.

BEFORE YOU TRAVEL

Ask a health worker whether your destination has malaria risk and if preventive medicine is advised.

A SIMPLE PLAN THAT SAVES LIVES

You can make a difference



1. **PREVENT**

   Protect against mosquito bites.

2. **TEST**

   Ask for a malaria test if you feel ill.

3. **TREAT**

   Follow the health worker's advice.

WHERE TO GET HELP

Visit your nearest clinic, health post or hospital.

TRUSTED SOURCES

WHO (2025). Malaria. who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/malaria
CDC (2024). Symptoms of Malaria. cdc.gov/malaria/symptoms/index.html
Botswana MoH (n.d.). Malaria can be Prevented. moh.gov.bw/malaria_prevented.html

PATIENT HEALTH EDUCATION



YOUR GUIDE TO

MALARIA

Prevent bites. Test early. Get treatment.

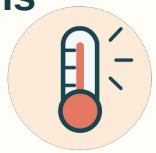
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01 / UNDERSTANDING THE CONDITION

What is malaria?

Malaria is an illness caused by parasites. It spreads mainly through bites from infected mosquitoes - not through everyday contact.

Look out for these signs



- Fever or chills
- Headache and body aches
- Feeling very tired or weak
- Sometimes nausea or vomiting

WHO NEEDS EXTRA CARE?

Young children, pregnant people and people with weakened immunity have a greater risk of serious illness.

02 / PREVENTION AND PROMOTION

Keep bites away

Simple habits can protect your family.



SLEEP UNDER A NET

Use an insecticide-treated mosquito net in malaria-risk areas.



COVER & PROTECT

Use mosquito repellent as directed, and wear long sleeves after dusk.



LOOK AFTER YOUR HOME

Cover water containers and empty standing water where safe.

ALSO: Repair window screens and follow local mosquito-control advice.

03 / MANAGEMENT AND CARE

Feeling unwell? Get tested early.

If you have a fever, chills or headache after possible mosquito exposure, visit a clinic promptly.



1. **Ask for a test**
   A health worker may use a rapid blood test or microscopy.
2. **Follow your treatment**
   Take malaria medicine exactly as prescribed. Finish the course.
3. **Check back if needed**
   Return for medical advice if symptoms persist or get worse.

URGENT DANGER SIGNS

Confusion, seizures, trouble breathing, or being unable to drink: seek emergency medical care immediately.

A malaria test and prompt treatment can save lives.